

Mehmet Ali Akyol, PhD

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EDUCATION

Middle East Technical University — *Ph.D.*

SEPTEMBER 2017 - SEPTEMBER 2024

Department of Information Systems

Middle East Technical University — *M.Sc.*

SEPTEMBER 2014 - SEPTEMBER 2017

Department of Information Systems

University of Essex — *Summer School*

JULY 2017 - AUGUST 2017

Took courses on Big Data and Analytics

Bilkent University — *B.Sc.*

AUGUST 2008 - JUNE 2013

Department of Electrical and Electronics Engineering

EXPERIENCE

Beko — *Senior Software Engineer, R&D*

NOVEMBER 2021 - Currently working

- Participated in R&D activities in the national IoT platform development and the EU's Horizon research projects, focusing on demand response and energy-related research projects, and helped secure approximately €1 million in funding for Beko.
- Conducted development and integrations on the AWS platform using services like Lambda, Athena, IoT Core, etc.

Thundra — *Growth Engineer*

AUGUST 2020 - OCTOBER 2021

- Worked on product analytics and created dashboards to visualize product usage metrics via funnels and cohort analysis.
- Created integrations between the core product and product analytics tools, building microservices using AWS Lambda, Serverless framework, and Node.js.

INTERESTS

Data Science
Big Data
Machine Learning
Cloud Computing
Project Management

SKILLS / TOOLS

#Python #R #SQL #Java #Scala
#Keras #Hadoop #Flink
#Spark #Kafka #Node.js #PHP
#Codeigniter #MySQL
#MongoDB #AWS #GCP #EC2
#Microservices #Lambda

AWARDS

Honorable mention in D4R
Big Data Challenge aiming for
social good for refugees in
Turkey among 60+ finalist
research groups around the
globe, including the ones from
MIT Media Lab, Imperial
College London, and Nokia Bell
Labs, 2019.

First place in the StartupBus
Europe Hackathon among 6
buses, 40 projects around
Europe, 2014.

Full scholarship from Bilkent
University, 2008-2013

Startup Buffer — Founder/*Software Developer*

June 2016 - October 2021

- Developed a web directory for emerging startups and iOS and Android applications using PHP, MySQL, AngularJS, Ionic, and Codeigniter. Featured 10,000+ startups across the world.

Middle East Technical University — *Research Assistant*

DECEMBER 2014 - AUGUST 2020

- Conducted research on cloud computing, big data, data mining, and machine learning. Worked as a teaching assistant for Cloud Computing, Data Mining, and Data Science courses.
- Developed projects on distributed computing using Apache Flink and Apache Kafka in addition to machine learning models such as clustering based on Self Organizing Maps, image classification models, and segmentation models using Keras and Python.

Aselsan — *Systems Design Engineer*

JANUARY 2013 - SEPTEMBER 2014

- Worked on designing radio networks and maintaining related software for various government agencies.
- Spearheaded a software-defined radio project, which expanded into a multi-million-euro program.

Ranked in the top 222 in the
Nationwide University
Entrance Exam (OSS) among
1.5 million students in Turkey
in 2008.

LANGUAGES

Turkish / Native
English / Advanced
German / Basic

SELECTED ACADEMIC PAPERS

- Akyol, M. A., Duzgun, S., and Baykal, N. "landusemix: A Python package for calculating land use mix." *SoftwareX* 27 (2024): 101861.
- Akyol, M. A., Temizel, T. T., Duzgun, S., & Baykal, N. (2024). Identification of Land Use Mix Using Point-Based Geospatial Data in Urban Areas. *Applied Sciences*, 14(16), 6871.
- Kılıç, Ö. O., Akyol, M. A., Işık, O., Kılıç, B. G., ... & Taşkaya-Temizel, T. (2019). The use of big mobile data to gain multilayered insights for Syrian refugee crisis. In *Guide to Mobile Data Analytics in Refugee Scenarios* (pp. 347-379). Springer, Cham.
- Akyol, M. A., Gökalp, M. O., ..., & Koçyiğit, A. (2017, September). A Context Aware Notification Architecture Based on Distributed Focused Crawling. In *European, Mediterranean, and Middle Eastern Conference on Information Systems* (pp. 29-39). Springer, Cham.

VOLUNTEER WORK

Web Summit

NOVEMBER 2015, IRELAND

Worked as a volunteer and participated at one of the biggest technology events in the world, having more than 42,000 attendees.